

HAVE YOU LOST YOUR NERVE?

Proverbs 30:15-16 (KJV) *“The horseleech hath two daughters, crying, ‘Give, give.’ There are three things that are never satisfied, yea, four things say not, ‘It is enough’: 16 The grave; and the barren womb; the earth that is not filled with water; and the fire that saith not, ‘It is enough.’”*

Last Sunday Susan preached a challenging sermon on this passage of scripture, and I would never attempt to try to top what she did with it. I feel the Lord has laid an additional thought on my heart that will prove to be a challenge to each of us.

The King James Version says, *“The horseleech hath two daughters, crying, ‘Give, give.’”* The *“Give, give”* here are reflexive verbs. A reflexive verb is spoken by the agent and performs an action that is

directed at the agent.

What I want to focus on today is the reflexes. Reflexes are routed from the nerve directly through the spinal cord, and then to the muscle - without ever going to the brain.

When you go to the doctor, he/she will usually check your reflexes. Have you ever wondered why they do such a thing? When you think about it, this seems to be a little peculiar. Until Susan preached last Sunday and mentioned this to me, I had never really thought about why the doctor does such a thing.

The doctor checking our reflexes is much more than an icebreaker between doctor and patient.

The doctor checks the reflexes to determine if there is something wrong with the nerves; to check to see if there is a back injury; to

make sure there is not a spinal cord injury. A bad or slow reflex can be an indicator of some diseases and nerve damage.

Proverbs declares the reflex of the daughters of the horseleech is to cry “***Give, give.***” Apparently the daughters of the horseleech make this declaration without thinking about it. Last week Susan challenged us to respond to vision in the same reflexive way.

Could it be that our reflexes are off because we have some nerve damage? Have we lost our nerve? Do we have the nerve to believe God for things that are bigger than we can do on our own?

As the Pastor of this church, I must bring myself to respond to the vision of the house, just like you have to respond to it. It is not my vision; it is God’s vision.

When the Board interviewed me to be the Pastor of CT Church, they were very emphatic that they were looking for someone who had the nerve to cast and implement vision.

I want to take the next few minutes and look at some folks in the Scripture that did not have to think about their response to the will of God:

- Noah – Hebrews 11:7 (NKJV) *“By faith Noah, being divinely warned of things not yet seen, moved with godly fear, prepared an ark for the saving of his household, by which he condemned the world and became heir of the righteousness which is according to faith.”*
- Three Hebrew Children – Daniel 3:8-16 (KJV) *“At that time certain Chaldeans came near, and accused the Jews. 9 They spake and said to the king Nebuchadnezzar, O king,*

live for ever. 10 Thou, O king, hast made a decree, that every man that shall hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, and dulcimer, and all kinds of musick, shall fall down and worship the golden image: 11 And whoso falleth not down and worshippeth, that he should be cast into the midst of a burning fiery furnace. 12 There are certain Jews whom thou hast set over the affairs of the province of Babylon, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego; these men, O king, have not regarded thee: they serve not thy gods, nor worship the golden image which thou hast set up. 13 Then Nebuchadnezzar in his rage and fury commanded to bring Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. Then they brought these men before the king. 14 Nebuchadnezzar spake and said unto them, Is it true, O Shadrach,

Meshach, and Abednego, do not ye serve my gods, nor worship the golden image which I have set up? 15 Now if ye be ready that at what time ye hear the sound of the cornet, flute, harp, sackbut, psaltery, and dulcimer, and all kinds of musick, ye fall down and worship the image which I have made; well: but if ye worship not, ye shall be cast the same hour into the midst of a burning fiery furnace; and who is that God that shall deliver you out of my hands 16 Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, answered and said to the king, O Nebuchadnezzar, we are not careful to answer thee in this matter. (One version say's "We don't need to think about this." They are about to take a reflexive action proving they have not lost their nerve) Notice verse 17 *"If it be so, (this refers to the king saying, "If you do not bow down, I am*

going to throw you into the fire”) ***our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace, and he WILL deliver us out of thine hand, O king. 18 But if not,*** (This does not refer to whether or not God will deliver, it refers to whether the king is going to throw them into the fire) ***be it known unto thee, O king, that we will not serve thy gods, nor worship the golden image which thou hast set up.***” The action of the three Hebrew Children was a reflexive action that proved they had not lost their nerve!

- John on Patmos – ***Revelation 1:10 (KJV)***
“I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day...” John was banished to the worst possible place and his reflex was to be in the Spirit of God. He did not have time to feel sorry for himself; his reflex was to be in the Spirit! John did not have any nerve damage!

If I were to check your reflexes today what would I find? Would I discover that you do not even have to think about what to do, that you automatically gravitate toward faith?

Would it be revealed that we trust in the flesh rather than trust in God? [Psalm 20:7](#) (NIV) *“Some trust in chariots and some in horses, but we trust in the name of the Lord our God”*

When we face hard times, do we have the nerve to trust God?

- Family problems – [Psalm 68:6](#) (NKJV) *“God sets the solitary in families; He brings out those who are bound into prosperity; But the rebellious dwell in a dry land.”* Do we have the nerve to believe God for household salvation?
- Financial problems – [Luke 6:38](#) (NKJV) *“Give, and it will be given to you: good measure, pressed down, shaken together, and running over will be put*

into your bosom. For with the same measure that you use, it will be measured back to you.” Do we have the nerve to give in the face of financial risk?

- Health problems – 1 Peter 2:24 (NKJV)
“Who Himself bore our sins in His own body on the tree, that we, having died to sins, might live for righteousness—by whose stripes you were healed.” Do we have the nerve to believe the report of the Lord rather than believing the report of the world?

PLACES PREACHED:

CT Church Houston TX 6/30/13

